

**COMMISSION FOR AIR QUALITY MANAGEMENT
IN NATIONAL CAPITAL REGION AND ADJOINING AREAS**

**GRADED RESPONSE ACTION PLAN (GRAP)
FOR THE NATIONAL CAPITAL REGION (NCR)**

(Revision: 29.09.2026)

1. The GRAP for the entire NCR has been classified under 4 different stages of adverse air quality in Delhi viz. Stage – I ‘Poor’ (AQI 201 – 300), Stage – II ‘Very Poor’ (AQI 301-400), Stage – III ‘Severe’ (AQI 401-450) and Stage – IV ‘Severe +’ (AQI >450) respectively.
2. Based on the dynamic model and weather/ meteorological forecast by IMD / IITM on a day-to-day basis, actions under Stages I, II, III and IV of the GRAP shall be invoked in advance of the AQI of Delhi reaching to the projected levels of that stage, also provided that the higher projected AQI levels are likely to sustain for longer period.
3. Even if the AQI forecast does not indicate the AQI of Delhi to be breaching a particular threshold and under extreme meteorological conditions or due to any episodic event the AQI breaches the threshold, that particular stage of the GRAP shall be invoked with immediate effect in respect of actions / measures that can be invoked immediately.
4. Restrictive actions undertaken as per previous stages shall be continued, in addition to the air pollution stage under which the restrictive actions are envisaged to be taken. For example, restrictive actions under the Stage III category, whenever invoked, shall be in addition to those under Stage I and II respectively and so on and so forth.
5. The Sub-Committee on GRAP constituted by the Commission shall meet frequently to plan for advance action and issue necessary orders for invoking various provisions of the GRAP, based on the prevalent air quality and the AQI forecast to be provided by IMD from time to time. The Sub-Committee shall also review the actions taken by various agencies responsible towards effective implementation of the GRAP.
6. The Chief Secretaries of NCR States and GNCTD shall frequently review the actions and implementation of the GRAP especially when the air quality falls or is likely to fall in the ‘Severe’ or ‘Severe +’ category (Stage III and beyond).
7. The Commission may decide upon any exceptions and additional measures to the schedule of the GRAP, under different air pollution categories i.e., Stages I to IV, as per the prevalent AQI and weather forecast.



Schedule under the GRAP for NCR

Stage I – ‘Poor’ Air Quality (DELHI AQI ranging between 201-300)	
Actions	Agencies responsible / Implementing Agencies
1. Ensure proper implementation of Directions/ Rules/ Guidelines for enforcement of dust mitigation measures (C&D materials & waste are properly stored & duly covered, transportation of C&D materials/ waste only in covered vehicles, yardsticks for anti-smog guns, water sprinkling etc.) in Construction and Demolition (C&D) activities and sound environmental management of C&D waste. 2. Ensure strict compliance of Direction Nos. 11-18 dated 11.06.2021 and do not permit C&D activities in respect of such C&D projects with plot size equal to or more than 500 sqm, which are not registered on the ‘web portal’ of the respective State / GNCTD and / or which do not fulfil the other requirements as per the above noted statutory Directions, for remote monitoring of dust mitigation measures.	- Chairpersons/ Member Secretaries – CPCB, DPCC, SPCBs (NCR). - Commissioners / Chief Engineers of Urban Local Bodies in Delhi-NCR towns. - Construction agencies and plot owners (both public & private).
3. Ensure regular lifting of Municipal Solid Waste (MSW), C&D waste, Industrial and Hazardous waste from dedicated dump sites/ industrial areas and ensure that no waste is dumped illegally in open land areas.	- Chairpersons/ Member Secretaries – CPCB, DPCC, SPCBs (NCR). - Commissioners / Chief Engineers of Urban Local Bodies in Delhi-NCR towns. - DMs/ DCs of respective districts in NCR. - All land-owning agencies. - Construction agencies (both public & private).



4. Carry out periodic mechanized sweeping and water sprinkling on roads and ensure scientific disposal of the dust collected in designated sites/landfills.	- Commissioners / Chief Engineers of Urban Local Bodies in Delhi-NCR towns. - Chief Executives of all road owning and maintaining agencies.
5. Intensify use of anti-smog guns, water sprinkling and dust suppression measures in road construction / widening / repair projects and maintenance activities.	- All road owning / maintenance agencies in NCR.
6. Strictly enforce prohibition on open burning of bio-mass and municipal solid waste. Impose maximum EC upon violations in accordance with Hon'ble NGT's orders dated 04.12.2014 and 28.04.2015 in OA 21/2014.	- Chairpersons/ Member Secretaries – CPCB, DPCC, SPCBs (NCR). - Commissioners / Chief Engineers of Urban Local Bodies in Delhi-NCR towns. - All land-owning agencies.
7. Strict vigil to ensure that there are no burning incidents in the landfill sites / dumpsites.	
8. Synchronize traffic movements and deploy adequate personnel at all identified corridors with heavy traffic, congestion points/ intersections for smooth flow of traffic.	- Commissioner or Head of Traffic Police in Delhi and NCR towns.
9. Strict vigilance and enforcement of PUC norms for vehicles and stop visibly polluting vehicles by impounding and / or levying maximum penalty.	- Commissioner or Head of Transport Department of Delhi and NCR States - Commissioner or Head of Traffic Police of Delhi and NCR towns.
10. Strictly enforce the Hon'ble Supreme Court's order regarding diversion of non- destined truck traffic for Delhi, through Eastern and Western Peripheral Expressways.	- Head of Traffic Police of Delhi and NCR towns. - DMs / Dy Commissioners of NCT of Delhi / NCR towns. - Municipal Commissioner of Corporations of NCT of Delhi and NCR towns.

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11. Strictly enforce NGT / Hon'ble Supreme Court orders regarding ban on plying of overaged diesel / petrol vehicles and other restrictions as per extant statutes.	- Commissioner or Head of Transport Department of Delhi and NCR States - Commissioner or Head of Traffic Police of Delhi and NCR towns.
12. Intensify inspection of industries including in non-conforming areas and ensure strict penal/ legal action against non-compliant and illegal units. 13. Strictly enforce all pollution control regulations in industries, brick kilns, hot mix plants etc. in NCR - strict compliance of the prescribed emission standards and use of approved fuels only.	- Chairpersons/ Member Secretaries – CPCB, DPCC, SPCBs (NCR). - District Magistrates / Deputy Commissioners of NCT of Delhi / NCR States. - Commissioners of Urban Local Bodies in Delhi and NCR towns.
14. Strictly enforce emission norms in thermal power plants and penal/ legal action be taken against non-compliance.	- Plant in- charge of Power Plants located within 300 km radius of Delhi. - Chairpersons/ Member Secretaries – CPCB, DPCC, SPCBs (NCR).
15. Strictly enforce orders of Hon'ble Courts / Tribunal regarding firecrackers.	- Commissioner of Police of Delhi & IG / DIG / SP of NCR towns or Officer In Charge of Licensing. - DMs/ DCs/SSPs of respective districts in NCR. - Chief Controller of Explosives, Petroleum and Explosive Safety Organizations (PESO).
16. DISCOMs to minimise power supply interruptions in NCR.	- Head of Power distribution companies in Delhi-NCR.
17. Ensure that diesel generator sets are not used as regular source of power supply. 18. Strictly implement the regulated operations of DG sets across all sectors in the NCR including Industrial, Commercial, Residential	

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etc. in accordance with Direction No. 76 dated 29.09.2023 with amendments, if any.

Capacity Range of DG sets	System to be adopted for control of emissions	Regulations for use
Power generating sets of all capacities running on LPG/ Natural Gas/Bio-gas/ Propane/Butane	None	No restrictions
Power generating sets up to 800 kW (1000 kVA) capacity to standards as per MoEFCC notification No. GSR 804 (E) dated 03.11.2022	None	No restrictions.
DG sets to older specifications / standards		
800 kW (1000 kVA) and above	Any emission control system/mechanism, however subject to compliance of the prescribed emission standards in Direction no. 76	No restrictions
41 kW (51 kVA) to less than 800 kW (1000 kVA)	Dual fuel mode OR Retro-fitted ECDs through certified agencies	No restrictions
19 kW (23 kVA) to less than 41 kW (51 kVA)	Dual fuel mode	No restrictions Note: DG Sets not working in a dual fuel mode, only owing to non-availability of gas infrastructure and supply, shall be permitted only for prescribed emergency services. *

- Chairpersons/ Member Secretaries – CPCB, DPCC, SPCBs (NCR).
- Commissioners / Chief Engineers of Urban Local Bodies in Delhi-NCR towns.
- District Magistrates / Deputy Commissioners of NCR States and GNCTD.



Portable DG sets below 19kW (23 kVA)	Presently no specific means of emission control are available in this category / capacity range of DG sets.	Not to be generally permitted. Permitted only for the prescribed emergency services. *	
Emergency services: (i) Only for operating elevators / Escalators / travelators. (ii) Medical Services (Hospital / Nursing Home/ Health care facilities). (iii) Railway Services / Railway Stations. (iv) Metro Rail Corporation & MRTS Services. (v) Airports and Inter-State Bus Terminals. (vi) Sewage Treatment Plants. (vii) Water pumping Stations. (viii) Projects related to national security, defence & of national importance. (ix) Telecommunications and IT/ data services.			
19. Do not permit inter-city/ inter-state buses from any city/ town of the states of Haryana, Uttar Pradesh, Rajasthan and also from the adjoining states of Punjab, Himachal Pradesh, Madhya Pradesh, Uttarakhand and J&K, other than EV / CNG / BS-VI Diesel, to ply in Delhi- NCR.	- State Governments in NCR and GNCTD. - Transport Commissioners, GNCTD/ NCR States - Commissioner of Police / Head of Traffic Police of Delhi and NCR towns.		
20. Strictly enforce the extant ban on use of coal / firewood as fuel in Tandoors in Hotels, Restaurants and open eateries and ensure use of only electricity / gas-based / clean fuel - based appliances in these establishments.	- Commissioners / Chief Engineers of Urban Local Bodies in Delhi-NCR towns. - Chairpersons/ Member Secretaries – CPCB, DPCC, SPCBs (NCR).		
21. Undertake intensive Information, Education and Communication (IEC) activities through print, electronic and social media, bulk SMS			

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etc. including issuing alerts to citizens about Do's and Don'ts for minimizing polluting activities. 22. Mobile Apps to be used to inform people about the pollution levels and contact details of control room to enable them to report polluting activities / sources to the concerned authorities and inform them about actions that would be taken by Government.	- ACS/ Pr. Secretary/ Secretary, Dept. of Environment, GNCTD and NCR States. - Chairpersons/ Member Secretaries – CPCB, DPCC, SPCBs (NCR).
23. Ensure quick actions for redressal of complaints on 311 App, Green Delhi App, SAMEER App, other such Apps and social media platforms to curb polluting activities.	- Head of Urban Local Bodies in NCR towns. - Chairpersons/ Member Secretaries – CPCB, DPCC, SPCBs (NCR). - Construction agencies, land owning agencies, Development agencies, Road owning agencies and all other concerned implementing agencies.
24. Encourage offices to start unified commute for employees to reduce traffic on road.	- State Governments in NCR and GNCTD.
25. Augment public transport services through CNG/ electric buses, metro and RRTS services by inducting additional fleet and increasing the frequency of service. Introduce differential rates to encourage off – peak travel.	- GNCTD and NCR State Governments. - Principal Secretary, Department of Transport. of NCT of Delhi and NCR State Govts. - Delhi Transport Corporation (DTC). - State Transport Corporations in NCR towns. - Delhi Integrated Multi – Model Transit System Ltd. (DIMTS). - Metro Rail Corporations (DMRC, NMRC, GMRL). - National Capital Region Transport Corporation (NCRTC).

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CITIZEN CHARTER

- Check AQI from SAMEER App and stage of GRAP in force from CAQM website.
- Keep engines of your vehicles properly tuned.
- Maintain proper tyre pressure in vehicles.
- Keep PUC certificates of your vehicles up to date.
- Do not idle your vehicle, also turn off the engine at red lights.
- Do not ply end-of-life / visibly polluting diesel or petrol vehicles.
- Prefer public transport or pooling of vehicles for commuting.
- Prefer EVs to control vehicular pollution. Ensure segregation and proper disposal of municipal solid waste.
- Do not litter / dispose waste, garbage in open spaces.
- Ensure disposal of waste only in designated collection points provided by municipal authorities especially in markets and public places.
- Ensure immediate removal of C&D waste and compliances of dust mitigation measures.
- Plant more trees and cover open spaces with grass and shrubs.
- Avoid using DG sets except for essential activities.
- Celebrate festivals in an eco-friendly manner – avoid firecrackers.
- Report air polluting activities through 311 App, Green Delhi App, SAMEER App etc.
- Participate in Information Education and Communication (IEC) activities and spread awareness about air pollution mitigation measures among fellow citizens through various means including social media channels.



**Stage II – ‘Very Poor’ Air Quality
(DELHI AQI ranging between 301-400)**

Actions	Agencies responsible / Implementing Agencies
1. Carry out mechanical/ vacuum sweeping along with water sprinkling of the identified roads on a daily basis preferably during night or early morning hours. Enhance the number of shifts / hours of deployment of such machines to further intensify mechanised sweeping and ensure proper disposal of the collected dust in designated sites/ landfills. 2. Ensure daily water sprinkling along with dust suppressants, before peak traffic hours, on roads and right of ways especially at heavy traffic corridors and other congestion points.	- Commissioners / Chief Engineers of Urban Local Bodies in Delhi-NCR towns - Chief Executives of all road owning and maintaining agencies. - Commissioner of Traffic Police of Delhi & NCR towns to identify roads with heavy traffic and provide information to respective Municipal Commissioners / Heads of Municipal Bodies.
3. Ensure focussed and targeted actions for abatement of air pollution in all identified hotspots in Delhi-NCR. Intensify remedial measures for the predominant sector(s) contributing to adverse air quality in each of such hotspots.	- State Govts. in NCR and GNCTD. - Chairpersons/ Member Secretaries – CPCB, DPCC, SPCBs (NCR). - Commissioners / Chief Engineers of Urban Local Bodies in Delhi and NCR towns.
4. Intensify inspections for strict enforcement of dust control measures at C&D sites.	- Chairpersons/ Member Secretaries – CPCB, DPCC, SPCBs (NCR). - Commissioners / Chief Engineers of Urban Local Bodies in Delhi and NCR towns.



5. Enhance vehicle parking fees to discourage private transport.	- Principal Secretary, Urban Local Bodies of NCR States and GNCTD. - Commissioners of Urban Local Bodies in Delhi and NCR towns.
6. Resident Welfare Associations (RWAs) to necessarily provide electric heaters (with provision of electricity supply / point) to staff engaged in security, sanitation, horticulture and other miscellaneous services to avoid open biomass/ MSW burning during winters.	- Resident Welfare Associations. - Municipal Commissioners / Heads of Municipal Bodies in Delhi and NCR towns.
7. (i) GNCTD and NCR State Governments to stagger timings for public offices and municipal bodies in the National Capital Territory of Delhi and the districts of Gurugram, Faridabad, Ghaziabad and Gautam Buddha Nagar. (ii) State Governments may take a decision to stagger timings for public offices and municipal bodies in other areas of NCR.	- GNCTD and NCR State Governments. - NCR State Governments.
8. Central Government may take a decision on staggering of timings of Central Government offices in Delhi – NCR.	- Central Government
CITIZEN CHARTER	• People to use public transport and minimize use of personal vehicles. • Use technology and take less congested route even if slightly longer. • Ensure proper parking, lane driving and clearance to pedestrian footpaths. • Regularly replace air filters at recommended intervals in your vehicles. • Avoid dust generating construction activities during the months of October to January. • Ensure cleaning of kitchen chimney filters at regular intervals. • Avoid outdoor smoke generating cooking and heating activities in residential areas and public spaces. • Avoid accumulation and open burning of solid waste and biomass. • People, whose positions allow working from home, may work from home.

**Stage III – ‘Severe’ Air Quality
(DELHI AQI ranging between 401-450)**

Actions	Agencies responsible / Implementing Agencies
1. Construction & Demolition activities: (i) Enforce strict restrictions on the following categories of dust generating/ air pollution causing construction and demolition (C&D) activities in the entire NCR: • Earthwork for excavation and filling including boring & drilling works. • Piling works. • All demolition works. • Laying of sewer line, water line, drainage and electric cabling etc. by open trench system. • Brick / masonry works. • Operation of RMC batching plant. • Major welding and gas-cutting operations. <i>Minor welding activities for MEP works (Mechanical, Electrical and Plumbing) to be, however, permitted.</i> • Painting, polishing and varnishing works etc. • Cement, Plaster / other coatings, except for minor indoor repairs / maintenance. • Cutting / grinding and fixing of tiles, stones and other flooring materials, except for minor indoor repairs/maintenance. • Road construction activities and major repairs. <i>Repairing of potholes shall, however, be permitted.</i> • Transfer, loading / unloading of dust generating materials like cement, fly-ash, bricks, sand, murrum, pebbles, crushed stone etc. anywhere within / outside the project sites.	- NCR State Governments and GNCTD - Chairpersons/ Member Secretaries – CPCB, DPCC, SPCBs (NCR). - Commissioners / Chief Engineers of Urban Local Bodies in Delhi and NCR towns. - All construction agencies and plot owners (both public & private).



- Movement of vehicles carrying construction materials or C&D waste on unpaved roads.

(ii) All construction related activities, **other than those listed under 1(i) above**, which are relatively less polluting / less dust generating shall be permitted to be continued in the NCR, subject to strict compliance of the C&D Waste Management Rules, dust prevention/ control norms including compliance with the directions of the Commission issued from time to time.

(iii) All C&D related activities, including those under 1(i) above, shall be continued to be permitted only for the following categories of projects, however subject to strict compliance of the C&D Waste Management Rules, dust prevention/ control norms including compliance with the directions of the Commission issued from time to time:

- a) Projects for Railway services and stations
- b) Projects for Metro Rail Services and stations
- c) Airports and Inter State Bus Terminals
- d) National security/ defence related activities/ projects of national importance;
- e) Hospitals/ health care facilities
- f) Linear public projects such as highways, roads, flyovers, over bridges, power transmission/ distribution, pipelines, tele-communication services etc.
- g) Sanitation projects like sewage treatment plants and water supply projects etc.
- h) Ancillary activities, specific to and supplementing the above project categories.



2. Close down operations of stone crushers in the entire NCR.	- Chairpersons/ Member Secretaries – CPCB, DPCC, SPCBs (NCR). - Commissioner of Police - Delhi and DG of Police of NCR States. - District Magistrates / Deputy Commissioners of respective districts in Delhi and NCR States.
3. Close down all mining and associated activities in the entire NCR.	- Chairpersons/ Member Secretaries – CPCB, DPCC, SPCBs (NCR). - Commissioner of Police - Delhi and DG of Police of NCR States. - District Magistrates / Deputy Commissioners of respective districts in NCR.
4. NCR State Govts. / GNCTD to impose strict restrictions on plying of BS III petrol and BS IV diesel or below standard Light Motor Vehicles (LMVs) (4 wheelers) in Delhi and in the High Vehicle Density (HVD) districts of Gurugram, Faridabad, Sonipat, Ghaziabad and Gautam Budha Nagar. Note: Persons with Disabilities shall be permitted to ply BS – III Petrol / BS – IV Diesel LMVs, provided that these are specifically adopted for them and are run only for their personal use.	- State Governments in NCR and GNCTD. - Transport Commissioners, GNCTD/ NCR States - Commissioner of Police / Head of Traffic Police of Delhi and NCR towns.
5. GNCTD to impose strict restrictions on plying of Delhi - registered diesel operated BS-IV and below standard Medium Goods Vehicles (MGVs), in Delhi.	- State Governments in NCR and GNCTD. - Transport Commissioners, GNCTD/ NCR States - Commissioner of Police / Head of Traffic Police of Delhi and NCR towns.
6. GNCTD to not permit diesel operated BS-IV and below standard MGVs, registered outside Delhi, to enter Delhi.	- State Governments in NCR and GNCTD. - Transport Commissioners, GNCTD/ NCR States - Commissioners / Head of Urban Local Bodies in Delhi-NCR towns. - Commissioner of Police / Head of Traffic Police of Delhi and NCR towns.

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7. GNCTD to not permit diesel operated BS-IV and below standard Light Goods Vehicles (LGVs), registered outside Delhi, to enter Delhi.	- State Governments in NCR and GNCTD. - Transport Commissioners, GNCTD/ NCR States - Commissioners / Head of Urban Local Bodies in Delhi-NCR towns. - Commissioner of Police / Head of Traffic Police of Delhi and NCR towns.
8. (i) State Govts. in the NCR and the GNCTD to mandatorily conduct classes in schools for children up to class V in a “Hybrid” mode i.e., both in physical and online mode (wherever online mode is feasible) in the territorial jurisdiction of the NCT of Delhi and in the districts of Gurugram, Faridabad, Ghaziabad and Gautam Buddha Nagar. (ii) The NCR State Governments may also consider conducting classes for students up to Class V in a “Hybrid” mode as above in other areas in NCR. Note: The option to exercise the online mode of education, wherever available, shall vest with the students and their guardians.	- State Governments of NCR & GNCTD. - NCR State Governments.
9. NCR State Governments / GNCTD to take a decision on allowing public, municipal and private offices to work on 50% strength and the rest to work from home.	- State Governments of NCR & GNCTD.
10. Central Government may take appropriate decision on permitting work from home for employees in Central Government offices.	- Central Government (DoPT).
CITIZEN CHARTER	• Walk or use cycles for small distances. • Choose a cleaner transport mode to commute. • Combine short journeys and reduce trips. • Postpone private gatherings that increase traffic and outdoor exposure. • Do not use coal and wood for heating purpose.

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	• House owners may also provide electric heaters to security/other staff employed by them to avoid open burning of biomass / wood / MSW. • Follow hybrid mode for primary schools and work-from-home when instructed.
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**Stage IV – ‘Severe +’ Air Quality
(DELHI AQI > 450)**

Actions	Agencies responsible / Implementing Agencies
1. Stop entry of trucks i.e. Heavy Goods Vehicles (HGVs) into Delhi. <i>All LNG/ CNG / Electric/ BS-VI diesel trucks shall, however, be permitted to enter Delhi.</i>	- State Governments of NCR & GNCTD. - Transport Commissioners, GNCTD/ NCR States - Commissioners / Head of Urban Local Bodies in Delhi-NCR towns. - Commissioner of Police / Head of Traffic Police of Delhi and NCR towns.
2. Enforce strict ban on plying of Delhi - registered diesel operated BS-IV and below standard HGVs in Delhi. <i>All LNG/ CNG / Electric/ BS-VI diesel trucks shall, however, be permitted to enter Delhi.</i>	- State Governments of NCR & GNCTD. - Transport Commissioners, GNCTD/ NCR States. - Commissioner of Police / Head of Traffic Police of Delhi and NCR towns.
3. Ban C&D activities, as in the GRAP Stage- III, also for linear public projects such as highways, roads, flyovers, overbridges, power transmission, pipelines, telecommunication etc.	- Chairpersons/ Member Secretaries – CPCB, DPCC, SPCBs (NCR). - Commissioners / Chief Engineers of Urban Local Bodies in Delhi - NCR towns. - Nodal Officers of road owning agencies (Dust Control and Management Cells).
4. (i) State Govts. in the NCR and the GNCTD to mandatorily conduct classes in schools for children even for higher classes i.e. from class VI to IX and XI in a “Hybrid” mode i.e., both in physical and online mode (wherever online mode is feasible) in the territorial jurisdiction of the NCT of Delhi and in the districts of Gurugram, Faridabad, Ghaziabad and Gautam Buddha Nagar. (ii) The NCR State Governments may also consider conducting classes for students as	- State Governments of NCR & GNCTD. - NCR State Governments.



above in a “Hybrid” mode in other areas in NCR. Note: The option to exercise the online mode of education, wherever available, shall vest with the students and their guardians.	
5. State Governments may consider additional emergency measures like closure of colleges/ educational institutions and closure of non-emergency commercial activities, permitting running of vehicles on odd-even basis of registration numbers etc.	- State Governments of NCR & GNCTD.
CITIZEN CHARTER	• Citizens are advised to limit non-essential outdoor activity. • Children, pregnant women, elderly and those with respiratory, cardiovascular, cerebrovascular or other chronic diseases to avoid outdoor activities and stay indoors, as much as possible. If required to move outdoors, they are advised to wear mask. • Follow hybrid mode for schools and restrictions on other activities as and when instructed.

